

D.J. PARIS

1,600,886.

NAR's peak member count. Its own budget expects that number to keep falling.

D.J. Paris
Keeping It Real Podcast

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**YOUR TRADE
ASSOCIATION HAS
NEVER HAD TO
COMPETE FOR
YOUR DUES
BEFORE.**

This year, for the first time, it does.

NAR'S OWN 2026 BUDGET EXPECTS TO BOTTOM OUT NEAR 1.2 MILLION MEMBERS.

NAR peaked at 1,600,886 members in October 2022. Its 2026 budget models membership continuing to fall toward 1.2 million by 2027-2028 (The Real Deal, June 2026). At the same time, the American Real Estate Association picked up real institutional weight this summer: Compass International Holdings joined on July 28, and RE/MAX affiliates followed. A second national association with brand-name backing didn't exist five years ago. Now it does, and NAR knows it.

WHAT TO DO WITH THE LEVERAGE:

- 1** Ask what your dues bought you this year, in writing.
Not the mission statement. The
- 2** actual advocacy wins and the actual member services.
- 3** Look at what ARA is offering agents in your market.
You don't have to switch to know
- 4** your options changed.
- 5** Stop auto-renewing on the assumption there's no alternative.
There is one now, and that
- 6** alone is why the value conversation is worth having.

THE TAKEAWAY

**LOYALTY WITH NO
COMPETING
OPTION ISN'T
LOYALTY. IT'S JUST
THE ONLY CHOICE
YOU HAD.**

You have a second one now. Use it to ask better questions, not necessarily to leave.